international sovereignty. In reality, its economic system and thus its political policy is directed from outside. Neo-colonialism is also the worst form of imperialism. For those who practice it, it means power without responsibility and for those who suffer from it, it means exploitation without redress".[10]

Therefore, to Kwame Nkrumah, the neo-colonialism of today represented imperialism in its final and perhaps its most dangerous stage. In the past, it was possible to convert a country into a colonial territory. Today, this process is no longer feasible due to the presence of international laws and world public opinion. Once a territory has become nominally independent, it is no longer possible, as it was in the last century, to reverse the process. Existing colonies lingered on for quite some time but no new colonies were created. Therefore, in place of colonialism as the main instrument of imperialism what exists today is neo-colonialism.

Denunciations of neo-colonialism also became popular with some national independence movements while they were still waging anti-colonial armed struggle and, after they gained independence, they rejected both traditional colonialism and neo-colonialism. The NAM countries were pioneer's in their struggle against colonialism and neo-colonialism and wanted the establishment of a New International Economic Order.

In the late twentieth century, the Western nations, especially the United States, were often charged for the perpetration of neo-colonialism. They were charged with involvement in the affairs of the developing nations. Proxy wars, many in former colonized nations, were funded throughout this period. Cuba, the Soviet bloc, Egypt under Nasser, as well as some governments of newly independent African states, charged the United States with supporting regimes which they felt did not represent the will of their peoples, and by both covert and overt means, toppled governments which rejected the United States.

The Third African People's Conference held in Cairo in 1961 made a comprehensive summary of manifestations of neo-colonialism. The Conference considered neo-colonialism to be the survival of the colonial system in spite of formal recognition of political